

MASQUERADE '26

Building AI That Thinks, Responds, and Feels Human.

2-Day National Level Turing Challenge | MODE: Offline

ABOUT THE EVENT

Masquerade '26 is a unique 2-day national level Turing Challenge designed to give students practical, hands-on exposure to modern AI development. Unlike traditional hackathons where teams tackle different problem statements, this event centres on a single challenge inspired by the Turing Test.

Participants will learn the fundamentals of AI system development, build their own conversational AI systems, deploy them, and compete to create the most human-like AI experience — combining learning, implementation, deployment, and evaluation into one competitive experience.

OBJECTIVES

- Introduce students to modern AI development workflows.
- Provide hands-on experience with AI models and APIs.
- Encourage practical learning through project development.
- Promote teamwork and collaborative problem-solving.
- Enhance deployment and integration skills.
- Explore the concept of human-like AI interaction through the Turing Test.

EVENT STRUCTURE

The event unfolds across two days, combining a guided learning phase with an extended development and evaluation phase:

Day 1 — Orientation & Boot Camp

Day 1 opens with the inauguration and development guidance, followed by a hands-on boot camp covering the foundations every participant needs to compete effectively. Topics covered include:

- Introduction to Artificial Intelligence
- Large Language Models (LLMs)
- Prompt Engineering
- Conversational AI Systems
- API Integration
- AI Agent Development
- Deployment Basics
- Building AI-Powered Applications

Development begins on the afternoon of Day 1 and continues through to Day 2.

Day 2 — Development & Turing Test Evaluation

Participants continue building through the morning, followed by evaluation rounds, a final development sprint, and the concluding Turing Test judging.

Across the two days, teams work to:

- Design AI systems
- Develop conversational capabilities
- Integrate AI models
- Test interactions
- Deploy applications
- Submit endpoints for evaluation to the club system

TURING TEST EVALUATION

The final evaluation follows a Turing Test-inspired format. Each team submits a deployed AI system connected to the event platform. During judging, a judge interacts with two separate, anonymized chat windows — one containing a real human participant, the other a team's AI system.

After conversing with both for a fixed duration, the judge must determine which participant is human and which is AI. Teams whose AI systems successfully convince judges they are talking to a human earn the highest evaluation scores — directly testing the conversational quality and human-like behaviour of each system.

EVALUATION PARAMETERS

- Human-like Conversation
- Response Consistency
- Context Awareness
- Reasoning Ability
- Creativity in Interaction
- Technical Implementation
- Deployment Success

REGISTRATION & PARTICIPATION

Registration Fee	₹300 per participant
Expected Participants	250
Food Provided	Breakfast, Lunch, Snacks
Duration	2 Days (July 31 – August 1)
Mode	Offline

REWARDS & RECOGNITION

- Top 10 teams will be selected as finalists.
- Top 3 teams will receive cash prizes and certificates.
- Remaining finalist teams will receive AI tool subscriptions or special gift hampers.
- Participation certificates and goodies will be awarded to all participants.

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EXPECTED OUTCOMES

By participating in Masquerade '26, students will:

- Understand modern AI development workflows.
- Gain experience with AI APIs and deployment.
- Learn prompt engineering techniques.
- Develop practical project-building skills.
- Improve teamwork and communication.
- Experience real-world AI evaluation methodologies.

PROPOSED AGENDA

Day 1 — July 31

TIME	ACTIVITY
09:30 AM – 10:30 AM	Opening Ceremony & Welcome Address
10:30 AM – 11:30 AM	Development Guidance
11:30 AM – 01:00 PM	Workshop: How to Build an AI (Boot Camp)
01:00 PM – 02:00 PM	Lunch Break
02:00 PM – 04:00 PM	Workshop & Hands-on Session
04:00 PM onwards	Development Starts – Continues into Day 2

Day 2 — August 1

TIME	ACTIVITY
08:00 AM – 09:00 AM	Registration & Breakfast
09:00 AM – 11:30 AM	Development Starts
11:30 AM – 12:00 PM	Evaluation Round
12:00 PM – 01:30 PM	Lunch & Refreshments
01:30 PM – 03:30 PM	Final Development
03:30 PM – 04:00 PM	Break
04:00 PM – 04:30 PM	Final Evaluation & Judges' Evaluation
04:30 PM – 05:00 PM	Prize Distribution & Closing Refreshments